

MARUTI SUZUKI DZIRE

from the standard features. Maruti offers it as an accessory, but buyers might expect it to come standard.

The second row is a major upgrade. Gone are the angled seats of earlier generations, replaced by upright, supportive ones that are more comfortable for long journeys. The ride quality is much improved, with bumps and undulations better absorbed. Rear occupants also get AC vents (albeit positioned low) and two fast-charging ports.

Maruti Suzuki Dzire
Engine: 1.2-litre, 3-cyl petrol
Power: 81bhp@5,700rpm
Max torque: 112Nm@4,300rpm
Price: Between Rs 6.79 lakh and Rs 9.79 lakh (introductory prices)

Under the hood, the Dzire retains the 1.2-litre, 3-cylinder Z12E engine, shared with the Swift. Despite initial scepticism, this engine impresses with its liveliness, reminiscent of the iconic G13B. It produces 81bhp and 112Nm and is paired with either a 5-speed manual or a 5-speed AMT (Automated Manual Transmission). The manual features a gas-assisted clutch and slick shifter, delivering a rewarding driving experience. The AMT, though smoother than before, still exhibits some head-nod during shifts. The Dzire leads its segment in fuel efficiency, with ARAI-certified figures of 24.79 kmpl for the manual and 25.71 kmpl for the AMT.

What truly stands out is the ride and handling. The Dzire strikes a perfect balance between comfort and engagement. Its suspension tuning is softer than the Swift's, making it more comfortable for everyday use. Yet, it remains confident and agile through corners, even with the added weight and extended dimensions of a sedan. This distinction in driving dynamics between the two cars is commendable.

Priced between Rs 6.79 lakh and Rs 9.79 lakh (introductory prices), the Dzire commands a slight premium over the Swift. AMT variants are Rs 45,000 more expensive across the range. However, the Dzire isn't just a Swift with a boot anymore; it's a well-rounded, distinctive compact sedan. If you're in the market for an entry-level sedan, the Dzire deserves serious consideration. ■



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